

ration tools, for corporates and individuals. Most often, business transactions occur online.

Whizlabs' IT certification exam preparation solution offers mock exams, quizzes, revision notes, an online testing environment, and free technical support from authors. Exam Simulator services are available for Sun, IBM, PMI, Oracle, Microsoft, Cisco and Novell certifications with online training modules for Sun and Red Hat.

This solution comes with an 'Unconditional Money Back Guarantee', if the customer is not happy with the product. (Find the sample test papers on this month's Digit DVD.)

Their LAN/Web-based Skill Assessment solution includes test delivery and reporting which lets users access their preparation material from anywhere. With just a browser required to access the server, this system also helps users obtain percentile scores within a particular community. This feature helps corporates manage assessment procedures.

Whizlabs online training sessions, which cost anywhere between US \$300 (Rs 14,000) and US \$500 (Rs 23,500), per user license, apart from the cost of the product—are likely to save a company nearly four times the amount, in providing boarding and lodging facilities and travel expenditures; more importantly, it saves the company plenty of time. Online training sessions also remove location-based constraints.

Built with smart algorithms, Whizlabs' modules make it easy for participants to obtain test results and relevant feedback, almost immediately.

For the certification exams,



From left: The founders of Whizlabs—Purvesh Sharma, Pradeep Chopra and Kapil Nakra

Certify yourself – The Whizlabs way



I scored more than 85 percent in these tests. The certifications will help update my knowledge levels in these areas.

Vamsi Polimetla
Senior Systems analyst, NCS Singapore

Whizlabs' online training sessions come with an 'Unconditional Test Pass Guarantee', which means that customers will be reimbursed the entire course fee if they do not clear the exam for some reason!

Whizlabs has helped companies such as Cisco, Accenture, Infosys, Nucleus Software, Coface and Bunge in recruitment, skill assessment, employee evaluation and certification exam preparation. Apart from their corporate clients, Whizlabs has also helped thousands of individual customers—mostly software professionals, get certified.

With certifications becoming increasingly relevant to enhance career prospects, several IT companies are now using certifications as a standard to measure an individual's technical skills vis-à-vis industry standards.

Says Parag Phise, Vice-President (Testing) at Delhi-based Nucleus Software, "We purchased assessment tests for Java and other technologies. A lot of people in our company work on Java-based platforms. Whizlabs' reports and percentile scores make it easy for us to evaluate and enhance our skills."

Deepak Adlakha, a software engineer working with an offshore development centre in New Delhi, purchased training materials for Sun certifications. Says Adlakha, "The mock tests were extremely useful."

Vamsi Polimetla, a senior systems analyst at National Computer Systems, Singapore, availed of Whizlabs' services for SCEA, SCBCD, Java Web and Business Component (all Sun certifications). "I scored more than 85

per cent in these tests. While I'm not sure whether the certifications will directly benefit my career, they will help update my knowledge levels in these areas," he says.

Distance, therefore, is not a constraint when it comes to learning. Atlanta-based Rashmi Banthia, and Geoffrey Chu, based in West Virginia, are both looking to get certified in XML and UML (IBM), thanks to Whizlabs. "These guys are pretty popular in the software market," says Chu.

Next-Gen Learning Tools

With customers in over 90 countries, and a monthly turnover of \$40,000 (Rs 19 lakh) per month, the company is on an upswing. Customer referrals account for a large proportion of their sales.

India being an IT haven these days, Chopra firmly believes that there is a market for such services in India and abroad. "The availability of a large pool of IT talent and presence of global players in the Indian IT industry makes a big market for our kind of services," he says.

Future plans will expand their existing services across IT skills.

With biggies such as NIIT, Tata Interactive Services (TIS), Lionbridge and ICICI Convergys dominating the e-learning arena, Whizlabs, like the others, has recognised the changing trend in learning patterns—from conventional tools to e-methods, which not only saves time and resources, but facilitates easy testing as well.

Companies such as Whizlabs have given a new twist to the learning curve—will educational institutions take the cue? ☐

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